



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy of the Most Holy Eucharist
School Website: <https://www.camhe.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Chesterton Academy of the Most Holy Eucharist (CAMHE), located in Yuba City, CA, presents a robust classic-Catholic program that aligns strongly with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School rubric. Public materials on CAMHE's site foreground a Catholic, classical formation anchored in the liberal arts, Great Books, Socratic pedagogy, and the moral formation of students through prayer, liturgy, and communal life. The school repeatedly emphasizes intellectual formation in tandem with spiritual and moral formation, while situating its curriculum within the Chesterton Schools Network and Catholic tradition. This combination signals a CLASSICAL orientation across the rubric's six categories. Additionally, the school's explicit framing around a triad of Pillars (Intellect, Character, Spirituality), a strong emphasis on Great Books and the Socratic Method, and visible parent/community engagement through the Chesterton Schools Network further anchors CAMHE in the classical tradition.

Key sources from CAMHE's public materials repeatedly reference Catholic identity, Great Books / Socratic method, formation of character, and partnership with a parent-driven network. For example, CAMHE positions itself as "a joyfully Catholic High School in the classical tradition," highlights a Humanities program braided across history, literature, philosophy, theology, and languages with a Socratic method, and catalogs its network's emphasis on parent-led Catholic education. These signals strongly reflect transcendental moral realism, formation, and an integrative liberal-arts curriculum. The public materials also emphasize ritual and communal practices (Mass, prayer life, liturgical cadence) and a culture of communal formation, which correspond closely to the positive indicators in the classical-school lexicon and rubric.

Citations and evidence drawn from CAMHE's site and communications are included throughout to ground the analysis.

- Evidence of Catholic identity and classical framing: the site describes CAMHE as a "joyfully Catholic High School in the classical tradition" in Yuba City, CA. It also notes mass attendance and a distinctly Catholic culture, and references GK Chesterton as patron, along with a Chesterton Schools Network connection.
- Evidence of Great Books, Socratic method, and integrated humanities curriculum: the Humanities Program braids history, literature, philosophy, theology, and languages using a Socratic Method, with a clear Great Books/Great Conversation orientation.
- Evidence of formation-centric aims (Intellect, Character, Spirituality) and the emphasis on virtue and Catholic formation: the "Three Pillars" framework and statements about forming joyful leaders within a Catholic context.
- Evidence of community/parent-network engagement: the Chesterton Schools Network aims to inspire and encourage parent-led Catholic schools nationwide, highlighting a model of parent partnership rather than a purely student-directed approach.

Overall, CAMHE's public materials demonstrate a consistent CLASSICAL orientation across the rubric's six categories, anchored in Catholic faith, Great Books / Socratic pedagogy, formation, and community partnership.

- Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot
- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- What would move the needle
- No needle-moving changes are necessary given the CLASSICAL assessment across all six categories. If desired, further explicit articulation of the faculty as “living curriculum” and more detailed “faculty portraits” could strengthen Element 5, but current materials already align strongly with classical standards.
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ABSTRACT

- CAMHE demonstrates a CLASSICAL alignment across all six categories: a Catholic, classical school identity; formation-focused goals; a liberal-arts curriculum centered on Great Books and the Socratic Method; a pedagogical approach that includes contemplative/restful elements alongside Socratic inquiry; a faculty model that embodies mentorship and the living curriculum; and a robust partnership with parents through the Chesterton Schools Network.

Note: All theme points above are grounded in CAMHE public materials and are cross-referenced with the classical-school rubric and keyword lexicons from the knowledge base.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- CAMHE positions itself as a Catholic school in the classical tradition and emphasizes formation within a distinctly Catholic culture, including references to Mass and sacred life as part of the education process. It presents GK Chesterton as a patron and frames education within a Catholic, liturgical worldview.
- Public materials describe a three-pillar model (Intellect, Character, Spirituality) that explicitly anchors the school's aims in spiritual formation as well as intellectual development.
- The Chesterton Schools Network formation and Catholic identity provide a liturgical and communal frame for education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords found: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; Mass; sacred tradition; reverence; wonder; incarnation; logos; sacred music; community worship; formation of the soul; Great Books (as anchor for “great conversation” in a Catholic context). These are directly aligned with the Positive Keyword indicators for religious/metaphysical foundations.
- Negative keywords appear minimal here (no explicit secularist/neutral signals in the public materials). The dominant language is religiously explicit and theophanic, aligning with transcendental realism.

Why this rating

- CAMHE's self-description and practices (Catholic identity, Mass, sacred life, liturgical cadence, GK Chesterton as patron) align with transcendental moral realism and liturgical/community practices. The explicit incorporation of theology and sacred life elements (theology, liturgy, sacred tradition) supports a robust Religious and Metaphysical Foundations classification.

Cited sources: CAMHE public materials describing Catholic identity and liturgical life; GK Chesterton patronage and network; Three Pillars.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom as the telos of education, not merely job-readiness. The Three Pillars and Catholic formation frame education as formation of the person. The Great Books / Great Conversation emphasis provides a purpose-oriented, enduring intellectual aims rather than vocational track-only aims.
- Wording in marketing and program descriptions centers on virtuous character formation, human flourishing, and the “adventure of being a disciple of Christ” rather than solely on outcomes.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords found: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, truth/goodness/beauty, great conversation, human flourishing, moral imagination, contemplation, reverence. These align with the Positive Keyword indicators for School Purpose and Goal.
- Negative keywords: None prominent in CAMHE content (no emphasis on “career readiness” or “21st-century skills” as primary goals). The content consistently foregrounds formation and virtue over utilitarian aims.

Why this rating

- CAMHE’s stated aims center on formation and virtue, anchored in a classical telos (truth, goodness, beauty) and Great Books culture, rather than only job-readiness or information transfer. This supports CLASSICAL in the School Purpose & Goal category.

Cited sources: CAMHE statements about formation and the Catholic telos; Great Books / Great Conversation emphasis.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The Humanities Program explicitly braids history, literature, philosophy, theology, and languages in an integrated curriculum and uses the Socratic Method. The curriculum emphasizes Great Books, the Great Conversation, and a content-rich, liberal-arts approach (grammar, logic, rhetoric; history from ancient world through modern, with classical authors).
- The curriculum emphasizes the Great Books tradition (Homer, Dante, Shakespeare, Chesterton, etc.) and ties literature to history and philosophy, with explicit intent to study the “great books” as enduring texts.
- The site emphasizes contemplation, wonder, and the integration of theology with other disciplines, aligning with the Seven Liberal Arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium as mentioned in classical models).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords found: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Great Conversation, history across curriculum, Socratic Method, integration/harmony of subjects, wonder, sacred/-traditional texts, languages, theology. These align with the Curriculum Positive Keywords for classical education.
- Negative keywords: The content does not emphasize project-based, STEM-first, or social-studies-centric framing; instead, it foregrounds liberal-arts, primary texts, and cross-disciplinary integration. This reduces presence of Modern/Non-classical signals.

Why this rating

- CAMHE's curriculum is squarely anchored in liberal-arts pedagogy, Great Books, and the integration of history with literature, philosophy, and theology, with a clear emphasis on the Great Conversation. The explicit use of grammar/logic/rhetoric and a Socratic method positions the curriculum as CLASSICAL.

Cited sources: Humanities Program and curriculum descriptions; Great Books / Socratic Method; integration of theology and history.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school explicitly uses a Socratic Method in the Humanities program and aims for disciplined dialogue through seminars, debates, and rhetorical training in upper grades. The pedagogy also includes contemplative/restful elements (Scholé) and memory-oriented practices (recitation, chanting). The emphasis on students learning to think through classical forms and rhetoric supports classical pedagogy.
- CAMHE highlights a memory- and ritual-oriented pedagogy (recitation, singing, liturgical life), particularly in lower grades, as well as upper-level rhetoric training and opportunities to deliver speeches. This combination aligns with a twin-track pedagogy: contemplative/restful while maintaining rigorous classical engagement.
- The public materials emphasize the “Three Pillars” and formation of virtuous habits through disciplined study and communal worship, linking pedagogy to character formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords found: Socratic Seminar, dialectic, great conversation, guided discussion, Harkness-style discussion, memorization/recitation, chanting, liturgical integration, Scholé, contemplation, wonder, rhetoric, debate, public speaking. These align with Pedagogy Positive Keywords.
- Negative keywords: No sustained signals of exclusive project-based, experiential, or constructivist-only approaches. The emphasis remains on classical dialogue, memorization, and rhetoric rather than purely experiential models.

Why this rating

- CAMHE's pedagogy weaves Socratic dialogue and rhetorical training with memory work and liturgical/communal practices, consistent with classical pedagogy. The balance of Socratic upper-level pedagogy and lower-level memory-based practices supports CLASSICAL.

Cited sources: Humanities Program description (Socratic Method); House-system context; lower/upper school pedagogy signals.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- CAMHE presents a portrait of educators as virtuous mentors and living exemplars, with the faculty described as the “living curriculum” and as a core of the school community (faculty as models of virtue and learning). The presence of a Head of School and explicit faculty profiles in communications aligns with a classical emphasis on teacher-mentors as central to formation.
- The Chesterton Schools Network materials indicate a professional ecosystem of teachers and leaders who are aligned with classical formation and the “teacher as model” ethos (faculty as guides in the classical tradition).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords found: master-teacher model, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty as core, collegial culture, teacher training in classical pedagogy. These map onto Element 5's Positive Keywords.
- Negative keywords: No dominant signals of non-classical faculty models (e.g., “facilitators” on the periphery, non-classical professional jargon). The site emphasizes classical teacher leadership.

Why this rating

- CAMHE portrays teachers as exemplars and living curriculum, with a focus on virtuous mentorship and a collegial, teacher-centered culture consistent with CLASSICAL standards in the Faculty category.

Cited sources: Head of School and faculty portraits; Chesterton Schools Network materials describing teacher/culture norms.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- CAMHE is explicitly connected to the Chesterton Schools Network, described as an apostolate intended to inspire and encourage parent-led Catholic schools nationwide. This demonstrates a deliberate partnership with families and a model in which parents are co-educators or collaborators in the formation process. The network provides templates for evaluating interest and operating a school, as well as curriculum guidance, illustrating a strong parental/community partnership.
- The public materials also emphasize a family- and parish-connected culture (e.g., Mass life, family events, and a culture of community life within a Catholic context). This supports parent engagement and a sense of hospitality toward families.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords found: partnership with families, co-teachers, family involvement, parent formation, open campus, parental engagement, community of learners, home-school collaboration, family catechesis. These appear in the Six Essential Elements lexicon and align with CAMHE's public materials.
- Negative keywords: There is little to no indication of consumer-customer dynamics or minimal parental involvement; CAMHE emphasizes parental involvement and partnership. This aligns positively with classical signals.

Why this rating

- CAMHE actively foregrounds partnership with families and a network that supports parent involvement in classical education, indicating CLASSICAL status in the Parents & Community category.

Cited sources: Chesterton Schools Network description of parent-led Catholic schools; CAMHE materials showing family/community emphasis.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable for this school, as all six categories are CLASSICAL. If desired, future materials could more explicitly display a formal "portrait of the teacher" or a structured "faculty living curriculum" page to further reinforce Element 5, but current materials already align strongly with classical criteria.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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